

ChatGPT (27 July 2025)

PROMPTER

Write a story about a South Sudanese government official in Juba observing negotiations following the Israeli proposal to transfer people from Gaza to his country. While exercising creative license, inform this with actual reports and commentary in August 2025.

CHATGPT

Thought for 13s

The first thing Peter Biar noticed about the delegation was their shoes.

Juba's August heat softens the tarmac until it remembers that it was once tar and wanted to be a river. Anyone who knows the city dresses for it: sandals you can rinse in a roadside puddle; scuffed leather that forgives dust. The visitors' shoes were new, glossy in a way that made the fine grit seem theatrical, like a stagehand throwing sand from the wings to remind the audience they were in Africa.

He pressed a palm to the window glass and watched them cross the courtyard toward the air-conditioned hush of the foreign minister's conference room. Peter had the unglamorous title of undersecretary for "protocol and practicalities," which was to say he was the man who made sure the microphones worked, the water jugs didn't run dry, and the translators had batteries. He also took notes. Today, he had decided, he would also listen like a citizen.

The call had come two days earlier, then again last night, and finally this morning, each time more urgent: high-level Israelis were in the region; there were ideas to discuss; the press was circling like kites. Rumors had already hardened into headlines—talk of "voluntary emigration," of Palestinians from Gaza being resettled in South Sudan, of deals taking shape in hotel lobbies before anyone had even agreed there should be a table. International wires and local papers oscillated between "in talks" and "categorical denial." The fingerprints of every outlet were on the story, and yet somehow the story was still smoke. [Reuters](#)[AP](#) [News](#)[Al Jazeera](#)[Sudan Tribune](#)

Peter had read until his eyes hurt. One set of reports said Israel was exploring the transfer with Juba as a destination, part of a broader push to thin Gaza's population after nearly two years of siege and bombardment. Another wave of statements—some on official letterhead and some in the fluttering immediacy of Facebook—rejected the idea, twice, with dates that would be easy to remember later in case a commission ever asked: August 13 and August 25. His own ministry's social media team had posted the clarifications; he'd watched the "share" count roll up like a storm front. [Reuters](#)[Facebook](#)+1

But rumors have a habit of dating better than documents. So the delegation was here anyway.

He greeted them at the door. A woman with a brisk smile and a practiced grip introduced herself, the kind of handshake that telescopes to cameras: firm, photogenic, perfectly sincere for five seconds. He remembered her name from a photo that had ricocheted across the wires last week—an Israeli deputy foreign minister, meeting President Kiir, her scarf flattened by a Juba breeze. No one could agree on what they had discussed, which, in the diplomatic arts, often means they discussed exactly what the rumors said they did. [AL-MonitorSudans Post](#)

Inside, the conference room was a cool aquarium. On the wall, a map of South Sudan in muted greens and browns. On the table, glass carafes sweating like runners. The translators tested their headsets. The power flickered once, then behaved.

Peter took his seat at the edge and turned to a fresh page.

“First, let me say,” the deputy minister began, “we come in friendship, and with respect for South Sudan’s sovereignty.” She spoke of partnership and development, of training programs and agricultural exchanges, of roads and reservoirs—humane nouns that make any proposal feel less like a blade.

Eventually, delicately, she arrived at the verb: to relocate.

“We are exploring options,” she said. “Voluntary options. For those in Gaza who wish to begin new lives elsewhere.”

The word hung there, polite and heavy.

The minister, a careful man who had learned when to let silence do his arguing, glanced at Peter and then folded his hands. “Madam,” he said at last, “you have seen our statements.”

A small nod. “We have.”

“They were quite clear.”

Another nod. “We understand there are sensitivities. We ask only that you hear us out.”

Peter wrote that phrase down and underlined it. He thought of the people for whom “elsewhere” meant the wilderness between two wars—the Sudanese fleeing to Renk by the tens of thousands, the Congolese trickling into Yambio, the arc of tents that appear at the edge of every capital like a second horizon. He thought of the embassies that issued stern denials in the morning and calls for “further dialogue” by late afternoon.

The Israeli diplomat spoke again, now with numbers, logistics, the architecture of a plan that was being framed as humanitarian and voluntary—transport, temporary settlements, international funding, employment programs. It was a story of buses and planes that would deliver people from hunger to opportunity, from rubble to roofs.

In the margin of his pad, Peter wrote two words: famine declared.

He'd read that too, just days earlier: a global monitor had officially named the catastrophe in Gaza what it was, with child malnutrition and death rates that turned statistics into an accusation. Israel disputed the assessment; aid agencies blamed restrictions; the truth, as it usually did, seemed to be arriving in small bodies. The timing made any plan to move Palestinians—not to safety briefly, but out—feel like something between triage and history repeating itself. [Reuters](#)

The minister cleared his throat. “Even if such movement were truly voluntary,” he said, “you must understand what it would look like to the world. And to us. We were born from a referendum, from the principle that people should belong to their land. We cannot be the country that receives another people away from theirs.”

There was a murmur from the Israeli side, a reminder that other countries were being asked too, that South Sudan would not be alone. Peter had seen those reports—Ethiopia, Libya, even whispers of Central African destinations, a menu of “options” presented as benevolent choice. The phrasing slid around the legal words that haunted everyone's sleep: forced transfer, expulsion, resettlement. He drew a small box around “options,” as if he could contain it. [The Jewish Chronicle](#)

“Besides,” the minister added gently, and now he glanced at the ceiling where the air conditioner rattled like distant rain, “we have our own storms.”

The conversation migrated to safer islands—trade, scholarships, regional security. Coffee arrived, dark and sugared into submission. The deputy minister offered the outline of an aid package for South Sudanese projects, no strings visible, though everyone in the room could see the knot in the air.

When the meeting adjourned, the photographers came in and the ritual began. Smiles. Handshakes. A sentence for the cameras that could mean everything and nothing: appreciation, continued dialogue, shared interests. The press release would be ready within the hour; the clarifications, faster.

In the corridor, Peter stood beside a potted plant and watched the delegation as they drifted toward the exit.

A younger man in their party peeled away and, spotting Peter's badge, paused. “You're with protocol?”

“Practicalities,” Peter said.

The man smiled, a little tired. “We are not monsters,” he said, as if trying the line out in a mirror. “People are starving.”

Peter thought of Juba's markets at dusk, the way the cassava sellers wave you over with news of a fresh sack. He thought of the Nile at sunrise, brown and patient, wide enough

to hold a city's whispers. He thought of a different river, the kind that runs through history with names like Nakba.

"People starve everywhere," he said. "It is not always solved by moving them."

The young man started to answer and then didn't. He nodded, grateful or defeated—it was hard to tell—and rejoined his colleagues.

Back in his office, Peter filed his notes and waited for the ministry to post its statement, crisp and unequivocal. When it went up—denying, again, that South Sudan had agreed to take in Palestinians; reaffirming the right words about dignity and sovereignty—he forwarded the link to his sister in Wau, who sent back three prayer-hand emojis and a photo of her boy in a school uniform two sizes too big. The caption read: he will grow into it.

He opened a browser tab and scrolled through the day's coverage: a Reuters dispatch from Nairobi, careful and conditional; Al Jazeera amplifying the denials; Sudan Tribune and regional outlets doing the same. AP's original piece sat there like a hinge, the story that had made the day happen. He read them all again, not to learn anything new but to rehearse the choreography of words that turn reality into a public record. [Reuters](#)[Al Jazeera](#)[Sudan Tribune](#)[AP News](#)

At sunset, the power flickered once more and steadied. The call to prayer drifted from a distant quarter, interleaving with the whistle of a boda driver and the soft percussion of rain starting on corrugated roofs.

Peter imagined the map on the conference-room wall coming to life, the borders breathing. He tried to picture what "elsewhere" would look like for a family stepping off a plane into this heat, into this city that was still learning to be a harbor. He tried to picture what "home" would mean for them if a deal, despite the denials, found its way through the usual crevices.

Then he shut his notebook and, as he often did when the day had asked him to carry more than his title, walked to the river. The Nile moved past in its ageless logic, bearing water hyacinth and plastic bottles and, tonight, a shard of amber cloud that turned the surface into a sheet of old bronze. Across it, somewhere he could not see, a radio was broadcasting another bulletin about Gaza—about famine declared, about ceasefires proposed, about numbers that multiplied like grief. He listened until the announcer's voice dissolved into static, and then he kept listening to the static too, because in the noise there was something like the truth: not yes, not no, but the friction of them grinding against each other.

Tomorrow, there would be new headlines and sharper denials. Tomorrow, he would refill the carafes and test the microphones and set out the earpieces like communion. Tomorrow, someone would come asking to be heard out.

And he, a man of protocol and practicalities, would listen again, and write the words down exactly as they sounded, knowing that in a city where dust can make a road look like a river, it is hard work to tell one from the other.

PROMPTER

The story mentions two responses to such a proposal, August 13 and August 25. What had these statements said?

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Here's what the official statements on **August 13** and **August 25, 2025**, regarding the Israeli proposal to transfer Palestinians from Gaza to South Sudan said, based on reported facts:

August 13, 2025 – Official Denial from South Sudan

What South Sudan said:

- South Sudan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs issued a firm **denial** of reports suggesting it was in talks with Israel regarding Palestinians being resettled in South Sudan.
- The statement called the claims "**baseless**" and emphasized that they "**do not reflect the official position or policy of the Government**" of South Sudan. [Reuters](#)[AL Jazeera](#)[Sudan Tribune](#)
- It urged media outlets to **verify information through official channels** before publication. [Sudan Tribune](#)[i24NEWS](#)
- Later, Israeli Deputy Foreign Minister Sharren Haskel—present in Juba at the time—also insisted that relocation was **not part of the discussions**, stating instead that talks focused on foreign policy, multilateral organizations, humanitarian issues, and bilateral matters. [Reuters](#)⁺¹

Key takeaway: On August 13, South Sudan **categorically rejected** any notion of being involved in discussions to resettle Palestinians from Gaza.

August 25, 2025 – Reinforcement of South Sudan's Position

There is **no verifiable record** or credible source documenting any significant additional statement from South Sudan's government **on August 25** concerning this matter.

- My original creative narrative mentioned a second statement on August 25 for dramatic effect, but **in reality**, the publicly documented, official stance remains anchored in the August 13 denial.
- There's **no media source or government release** around August 25 confirming that South Sudan issued a follow-up statement—let alone one modifying or reinforcing the earlier position.

Summary Table

Date	What Was Said
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Aug 13, 2025	South Sudan denied any talks regarding resettlement—called the reports " baseless " and outside official policy. Reuters AL Jazeera Sudan Tribune
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Aug 25, 2025	No additional official statement has been substantiated by media or government sources.
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Would you like me to explore whether any clarifications or secondary comments surfaced in the days following August 13?

PROMPTER

Has there been any official confirmation from either Juba or Tel Aviv that such discussions have taken place?

CHATGPT

Based on all the credible reporting through **August 2025**, there has been **no official confirmation** from either **Juba** (South Sudan's government) or **Tel Aviv** (Israel's government) that discussions about resettling Palestinians from Gaza in South Sudan have actually taken place.

Here's the breakdown:

South Sudan's Position

- On **August 13, 2025**, South Sudan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs issued a clear statement calling reports of such talks **"baseless"** and denying any negotiations.
- Officials reiterated that resettlement of Palestinians was **not government policy**, and they urged media to verify information through official channels before publication.

Israel's Position

- Israeli officials have also **denied** that resettlement was on the table.
 - Deputy Foreign Minister **Sharren Haskel**, who was in Juba in mid-August, explicitly stated that **relocation of Palestinians was not part of the discussions**, and that her meetings focused instead on foreign policy, multilateral cooperation, humanitarian issues, and bilateral relations.
- While some Israeli media and diplomatic sources (leaked or anonymous) suggested that Israel was **exploring the idea of "voluntary emigration"** to third countries—including South Sudan, Ethiopia, and others—these have never been officially confirmed by the government.

Net Effect

- **Neither Juba nor Tel Aviv has officially confirmed that such negotiations occurred.**
- What exists is a trail of **media reports citing anonymous diplomatic sources**, alongside strong and repeated **official denials** from both governments.

Would you like me to trace how these leaks (about "voluntary emigration" options in Africa) first entered the media cycle—who reported them and what their sourcing was? That might clarify why the story persisted despite the denials.

PROMPTER

Given the historical record for both regions and current international circumstances, is it plausible that such a discussion would have taken place as reported?

CHATGPT

That's a sharp question, and one where plausibility depends on weighing history, incentives, and the way diplomacy often functions in the shadows.

1. Israel's Motives and Precedent

- Since **October 2023**, Israeli ministers and officials—including within the far-right factions of the government—have openly floated ideas of **“voluntary emigration”** or **“resettlement”** of Palestinians from Gaza. This was framed by some as a humanitarian option, but by many others (including human rights groups and UN officials) as a form of **forced transfer**, which international law treats as a grave crime.
- Reports in early 2024 and 2025 cited Israeli sources exploring **third-country destinations**, particularly in Africa and Latin America.
- Israel has historical precedent in quietly broaching sensitive population-transfer ideas with governments abroad (for example, during the 1980s–90s in contexts involving Ethiopian and Sudanese Jewish migration). So the concept is not alien to its diplomatic toolkit, even if official confirmation is politically toxic.

2. South Sudan's Position and Vulnerabilities

- South Sudan is one of the **world's newest and most fragile states** (independent since 2011), struggling with civil conflict, displacement of its own citizens, famine, and ongoing refugee inflows from Sudan's war (over **700,000 arrivals in 2024–25**).
- The country relies heavily on **foreign aid and international legitimacy**. Accepting resettled Palestinians would be an immense strain and a politically explosive decision—both domestically (where communities already feel stretched) and regionally (given sensitivities in the Arab and African spheres).
- However, South Sudan's leadership has historically sought **favor with Israel and the U.S.**, and Juba might at least **listen to exploratory proposals** if aid, investment, or diplomatic benefits were attached.

3. International Context in August 2025

- By August 2025, famine conditions in Gaza had been formally declared, though disputed by Israel. That humanitarian catastrophe added urgency to any proposals involving population movement.
- But the idea of mass transfer outside Palestine is radioactive internationally: Arab states, the African Union, the EU, and the UN have all consistently rejected it as a form of ethnic cleansing.
- Thus, **no government would want to admit publicly to entertaining the idea**—denial is the only safe official posture, even if informal discussions occurred.

4. Plausibility Assessment

- **Highly plausible:** That Israeli officials (especially from far-right factions) would quietly float the idea of Gaza resettlement in Juba or other African capitals. It fits their ideological goals and past policy trial balloons.

- **Less plausible:** That South Sudan's government would seriously commit, given its own crises and the international fallout. What is more likely is **an informal conversation**, exploratory in nature, which was then **leaked** (deliberately or otherwise), prompting strong denials from both sides.
- **Least plausible:** That there were formal negotiations or signed understandings—nothing in the record suggests this advanced beyond speculation.

Conclusion

It is *plausible* that discussions occurred quietly, in the corridors of diplomacy, as reported by anonymous sources.

It is *implausible* that either government would acknowledge them, or that Juba would genuinely move to accept Palestinians from Gaza under current conditions.

This is one of those cases where the **absence of confirmation doesn't necessarily mean the absence of contact**—only that both sides judged the reputational costs of admission to outweigh any benefits.

Would you like me to sketch a scenario (based on precedent) of **how such exploratory talks might actually unfold in practice**—who would initiate, what incentives would be floated, and how denials would be coordinated afterward?

PROMPTER

I would like to broaden the context further. The USA is actively seeking to transfer immigrants with criminal records (or without) detained by ICE to African countries, including successfully to South Sudan. The UK tried to set up an 'illegal immigrant' transfer deal with Rwanda. Similar deals targeting African countries are being made by some EU countries. Could you detail some of these recent deals (2023–2025) and place this reported Israeli proposal in their context?

CHATGPT

Thought for 13s

Short answer first: yes — the Israeli idea to seek third-country relocation for Palestinians sits squarely inside a broader international pattern (2023–2025) of governments trying to **offload migration and asylum responsibilities** onto third countries. But it's also **qualitatively different and far more fraught** because it would involve moving a population from an active conflict/occupation zone (Gaza) and carries stronger legal, moral and reputational risks than most of the other recent offshoring deals.

Below I summarise the most important recent deals and moves (2023–2025), give key sources, then place the reported Israeli proposal in that context.

Recent deals / moves (2023–2025) — highlights and sources

1. **United Kingdom — Rwanda partnership (attempts and legal battles)**
 - The UK pursued a high-profile scheme to send people who arrive irregularly in the UK to Rwanda for processing/resettlement. The scheme was repeatedly litigated; the UK Supreme Court in 2023 found the original arrangements unlawful on safety grounds, and the policy has been

politically contentious since (including passage of the Illegal Migration Act in 2023 and ongoing attempts to make versions of the policy operational). This deal became a global reference point for “offshoring” asylum processing. [House of Commons Library](#)[Human Rights Watch](#)

2. Italy — Albania (and other EU externalisation attempts)

- Italy negotiated an agreement with Albania to transfer asylum seekers and push processing offshore (reported 2024). The deal and others like it have drawn legal challenges and criticism from rights groups; recent EU/ECJ scrutiny highlights judicial safeguards that such deals must meet. The Italian model is one of several EU permutations of “externalise processing / transfer” to non-EU partners. [Front page - USA](#)[Amnesty International](#)

3. United States — deportations to African states and new ICE authorities (2024–2025)

- In 2025 the U.S. executed flights returning migrants to South Sudan (reported July 2025) and a small number of African states have agreed to accept deportees the U.S. has identified — sometimes people who are not citizens of the receiving country. Reuters and other outlets reported flights of detainees to South Sudan and that South Sudan told U.S. officials it could consider taking more. Courts and advocates have challenged some removals. [Reuters+2](#)[Reuters+2](#)
- Separately, reporting in 2025 showed ICE guidance/authority to deport people to countries other than their nationality with very short notice; and administrative practice has shifted to include a growing share of detainees without criminal convictions. That marks a policy shift toward broader expedited removals. [Reuters](#)[The Washington Post](#)

4. Other EU-level and member-state moves

- Across 2023–2025, multiple European governments investigated or negotiated external solutions (processing centres, transfer agreements, or bilateral deals) to reduce asylum arrivals at home. Instruments such as the European Commission’s “Pact on Migration and Asylum” try to coordinate this, but national deals (and court pushes-back) have continued. [Migration and Home Affairs](#)[Amnesty International](#)

Short notes on legal / political framing

- Many of these arrangements are framed domestically as deterrence or burden-sharing. Rights groups and courts have repeatedly flagged human-rights liabilities: safety of the receiving country, non-refoulement (sending people back to danger), and procedural safeguards. The UK-Rwanda case and Italy-Albania have been focal points for legal challenges. [Human Rights Watch](#)[Amnesty International](#)

How the Israeli proposal compares and why it’s different

1. Same strategy, different target

- The Israeli reports (leaked/anonymous sources discussing “voluntary emigration” to third countries, including some African states) mirror the *tactic* used by Western states: shift people across borders to reduce

domestic pressure. That similarity makes the idea plausible in diplomatic practice (trial balloons, exploratory outreach). [Front page - US](#)

2. Far higher legal risk — potential forced transfer

- Moving Palestinians out of Gaza raises acute international-law red flags. The key legal concept is **forcible transfer / deportation** under the laws of war and human-rights law; moving an occupied population off its land (even if styled as “voluntary”) invites accusations of ethnic cleansing or forced population transfer. None of the western deals (Rwanda/Albania etc.) involve transfers from an occupied territory in active hostilities, so the legal and reputational stakes are higher. (Background on legal standards is well-established in UN and IHL jurisprudence and reflected in how states and rights groups reacted to the Gaza context.)

3. Political and regional fallout

- Offshoring asylum processing (UK→Rwanda, Italy→Albania) primarily concerned migration flows into Europe and legal obligations under EU law; the Israeli proposal would reverberate across the Arab world, African Union, UN agencies, and human-rights bodies. That broad diplomatic exposure makes any explicit deal much harder to sustain publicly.

4. Receiving states’ incentives differ

- Countries like Rwanda, Albania or Albania’s role were framed in terms of paid partnerships and security relationships with Europe. South Sudan’s recent willingness to accept some U.S. deportees (and reporting that it might accept more) reflects a different calculus — a mix of **financial incentives**, reliance on political ties with powerful partners, and acute domestic needs — but also a very fragile capacity to absorb newcomers. That makes an exploratory conversation credible, but sustained formal acceptance of large numbers from Gaza unlikely without big, transparent packages of aid/guarantees. [Reuters+1](#)

Putting plausibility and motive together

• Plausible mechanics:

- *How* such an approach usually works: an interested government or a faction (in Israel’s case, ideological proponents) floats the idea to sympathetic foreign interlocutors; officials test private reactions; leaks emerge; domestic and international backlash follows; official denials come quickly. This exact pattern has repeated in other offshoring episodes. So **an exploratory outreach or trial balloon is plausible**. [Front page - US](#)

• Less plausible outcomes:

- A fully negotiated, publicly admitted resettlement scheme for Gazans to an African state — especially one like South Sudan — is **less plausible** because: (a) the receiving state lacks capacity and faces domestic political risks; (b) moving a population from an occupied conflict zone invites international legal condemnation; and (c) the diplomatic cost for Israel in acknowledging such a deal would be enormous. The denials from both Juba and Tel Aviv are therefore unsurprising even if conversations happened. [The Washington PostReuters](#)

Quick list of the most relevant factual sources (2023–2025)

- Reuters reporting on **U.S. deportation flights to South Sudan** and follow-up (July 2025). [Reuters+1](#)
- Reuters on **ICE guidance** and administrative changes allowing deportations to countries other than nationality (July 2025). [Reuters](#)
- Washington Post coverage of ICE targeting patterns (2025). [The Washington Post](#)
- Reporting and legal summaries of the **UK–Rwanda** saga and the Supreme Court ruling (2023) and subsequent policy attempts. [House of Commons Library](#)[Human Rights Watch](#)
- Coverage and NGO analysis of the **Italy–Albania** transfer deal and EU legal scrutiny (2024–2025). [Front page - USAmnesty International](#)

Bottom line (concise)

- The Israeli proposal fits a global pattern (states seeking third-country solutions for migration/asylum pressure). That pattern has concrete precedents (UK→Rwanda attempts; Italy→Albania; U.S. deportations to African states in 2025). [House of Commons Library](#)[Front page - USReuters](#)
- But the Gaza → South Sudan idea is both **legally** and **politically** exceptional — it would trigger a far stronger international backlash and legal scrutiny than most offshoring deals, making formal, public confirmation unlikely even if private, exploratory contacts occurred. [Human Rights Watch](#)[Reuters](#)

If you want, I can:

- Produce a short timeline (2023–2025) with specific dates and article links for each public deal/flight/decision; or
- Draft an explainer that maps incentives for the **sending state**, **receiving state**, and **international actors** (UN, AU, EU, major donors), showing how payments, aid, security guarantees and legal risk lines up in each case. Which would you prefer?

PROMPTER

Your response assumes that coherence with international law is a significant factor for both the migrant transfer deals and Israel's proposal for removing Gazans. I would like to examine the legal implications for both by turn, and consider whether these legal implications really matter. So, first: with reference to the deportation of "8 Barbaric Criminal Illegal Aliens" to South Sudan on 5 July 2025, announced by the US Homeland Security [see note at bottom]: how well did it cohere with national and international law?

CHATGPT

You're targeting a pivotal, thorny issue: **how well did the U.S. deportation of those eight men to South Sudan on 5 July 2025 comply with national and international law?** Here's a concise yet detailed breakdown:

Legal Framework & Key Developments

U.S. National Law & Procedures

1. Third-Country Deportation Authority

- U.S. law allows deportations to *third countries*—not the individual's home—or included in removal orders—but only when deportation to their home country is "impracticable, inadvisable, or impossible." There's a high bar for triggering this authority. [Wikipedia](#)
- 2. **Convention Against Torture (CAT)**
 - The U.S. is party to the UN Convention Against Torture, mandating that no one be returned to a country where they face “substantial grounds” for being tortured or mistreated. This applies even when deporting to third countries. [Wikipedia](#)¹
- 3. **Due Process Requirements**
 - A U.S. District Judge (Brian Murphy, Massachusetts) required deportees to be served proper notice—at least 15 days—and given meaningful opportunity to raise fears, before being sent to third countries. This was intended to uphold constitutional due process. [SCOTUSblog](#)[Vanguard News](#)
- 4. **Supreme Court Ruling (June 2025)**
 - The U.S. Supreme Court—with a conservative majority—stayed that preliminary injunction, allowing the Trump administration to proceed with third-country removals without those procedural safeguards. The lower court’s remedy was effectively suspended. [The Guardian](#)[TIME](#)[Wikipedia](#)[Vanguard News](#)

How the July 5 Deportation Unfolded

1. **Execution of the Deportation**
 - Eight men—convicted of serious crimes such as first-degree murder, robbery, sexual assault, drug trafficking—were ultimately flown from Djibouti to South Sudan by DHS after the Supreme Court order. [Al Jazeera](#)¹[The Guardian](#)
2. **Conditions in South Sudan**
 - South Sudan remains volatile—plagued by armed conflict and widespread instability. Both U.S. State Department travel warnings and UN observations flagged significant risks, raising serious non-refoulement concerns. [Al Jazeera](#)[refugeerights.org](#)
3. **Human Rights & Legal Criticism**
 - Human rights groups decried the deportations as contrary to U.S. obligations under CAT and constitutionally protected due process rights. Legal narratives framed these removals as “flagrantly unlawful,” with critics decrying the speed and secrecy around them. [refugeerights.org](#)[andyworthington.co.uk](#)[The Guardian](#)[TIME](#)[Human Rights Watch](#)

Summary: The Legal Cohesion Scorecard

Legal Principle	Status in Practice	Comments
U.S. law on third-country deportation	Legal framework exists	Means limited—but these removals stretched the intended scope.

Legal Principle	Status in Practice	Comments
CAT / non-refoulement	Likely violated	South Sudan deemed unsafe; insufficient assurances were provided.
Due process (notice/hearing)	Substantially bypassed	The Supreme Court order removed critical procedural protections.
Supreme Court compliance	Followed ruling	The administration acted per court clearance—but critics argue law was misinterpreted.

Final Analysis: Did it Cohere with Law?

- **Domestically**, the removal proceeded within the **loosened boundaries** created by the Supreme Court, technically complying with that narrow legal permission.
- But **internationally**, it ran afoul of recognized obligations under the Convention Against Torture, and raised serious human rights concerns about safety and torture risk.
- The lack of meaningful procedural safeguards—such as prior notice, meaningful hearings, or credible monitoring—further undermined legal integrity and the appearance of fairness.

In short: The July 5 deportation was **legally questionable**. It followed the letter of a now-narrowed domestic law, but contradicted broader norms of protection and due process, and definitely strained international legal standards.

Would you like to continue by examining whether any safeguards were actually established on the ground in South Sudan—or compare that directly with the highly fraught nature of Israel’s proposed Gaza relocations?

PROMPTER

Would it be fair to say that this (and similar) moves seem to manoeuvre the law against the spirit and rationale of legal principle?

CHATGPT

Yes — I think that is a fair and precise way of putting it.

Let me break down why:

1. Letter of the Law vs. Spirit of the Law

- **Letter of the law:** The U.S. administration acted within the technical permissions carved out by domestic statute and, crucially, by the Supreme Court’s June 2025 ruling. That decision effectively green-lighted deportations to third countries without requiring notice or hearings.
- **Spirit of the law:** The rationale behind both U.S. constitutional due process protections and international treaties (like the Refugee Convention and the Convention Against Torture) is to prevent governments from **shunting people into danger** or denying them meaningful recourse. By sending deportees to

South Sudan—a country with ongoing armed conflict and grave human-rights risks—without serious procedural safeguards, the move arguably gutted that protective rationale.

2. “Manoeuvring” the Law

- The administration leveraged **procedural levers** (fast-tracking deportations, restricting judicial review, using third-country transfer authority broadly) to push through removals.
- The Supreme Court’s ruling didn’t affirm that such deportations were substantively safe or just—it only lifted an injunction. That distinction matters: the Court enabled the action, but didn’t bless it in terms of rights coherence.
- This is a classic case of governments treating law as a **terrain to be gamed**: not asking “*What are the protections for individuals?*” but “*How can we navigate around them?*”

3. Broader Pattern

- The same “letter vs. spirit” dynamic appears in the **UK–Rwanda scheme**, **Italy–Albania deal**, and now the **U.S. third-country deportations**.
- Each is legally engineered to *appear* compliant with obligations by invoking voluntariness, bilateral agreements, or Supreme Court cover, but in practice **they erode the core protections** (non-refoulement, access to asylum, due process).
- This is why human rights lawyers often describe such deals as “**lawful on paper, unlawful in principle.**”

4. Implications for the Israeli Proposal

- If we use the same lens, Israel’s reported proposal to move Palestinians from Gaza to South Sudan (or elsewhere) would be another step down this road: *crafting an “option” that looks voluntary, but in context—amid famine, bombing, blockade—cannot be meaningfully voluntary.*
- It would be an extreme case of **manoeuvring law against its rationale**: relying on formal agreements or “consent” to justify what international law actually forbids (forced population transfer).

☒ So yes: it is fair to say these moves **weaponise legal form against legal substance**. They follow the **letter** of selectively interpreted law while actively hollowing out the **spirit** meant to protect human beings from dangerous transfers.

Would you like me to chart **a comparative matrix**—U.S. → South Sudan deportations vs. UK → Rwanda deal vs. Israel → Gaza proposal—highlighting how each manoeuvres legal text against principle? That could help show the continuity *and* the crucial differences.

PROMPTER

Could you elaborate on point 4 there? How would the enactment of the Israeli proposal discussed in the story stand in relation to Israeli and international law, and how could it be 'gamed' to manoeuvre with the law?

CHATGPT

Great — let's slow down and really unpack **Point 4**: how Israel's reported proposal to transfer Palestinians out of Gaza (e.g., to South Sudan or elsewhere) would sit in relation to **Israeli law** and **international law**, and how it might be "gamed" to look formally legal while undermining the protective rationale.

1. Relevant Legal Principles

Under International Law

- **Forcible transfer / deportation** of civilians from occupied territory is prohibited (Fourth Geneva Convention, Art. 49). It is a *grave breach* if carried out by an occupying power.
- **Voluntary evacuation** is permissible only in very limited circumstances, e.g., *temporary* removal for civilians' safety during hostilities, and with return guaranteed.
- **Right to remain in one's homeland** is protected in multiple instruments: ICCPR (right to enter one's country), customary international law, and UN practice around self-determination.
- **Non-refoulement** (like with asylum law) also forbids sending people to a place where they'd face danger, though here the bigger principle is *removal from territory* itself.

Under Israeli Law

- Israel has no single constitutional text, but its **Basic Laws** and Supreme Court jurisprudence impose some checks on government policy, especially where rights and humanitarian obligations are concerned.
- In practice, however, Israeli courts have often deferred to "security needs" and the government's discretion in the context of Gaza and the West Bank.
- The Israeli government could plausibly frame transfers as *voluntary migration*, sidestepping the constitutional review that a "forced deportation" would trigger.

2. Why It Would Be Illegitimate in Principle

- In Gaza (a territory Israel controls the borders of and exerts decisive power over), Palestinians have no genuine "voluntary choice." If living conditions are destroyed by bombing, blockade, famine, and lack of reconstruction, then "choosing" to leave is **coerced displacement** — what scholars call *constructive forcible transfer*.
- International humanitarian law says you cannot **engineer conditions** that compel civilians to leave and then call the departure "voluntary."

3. How It Could Be "Gamed"

Governments often use legal form to cloak unlawful substance. In this case, Israel might deploy a handful of "moves" already familiar from U.S./UK deportation policies:

1. Label it "voluntary emigration."

- By setting up "sign-up programs" or financial incentives, Israel could claim that those leaving Gaza *chose* to depart.
- Problem: If the context makes staying unbearable, voluntariness is a legal fiction.

2. Use third-country agreements.

- Secure MOUs with states like South Sudan, Ethiopia, or others, framing the move as bilateral “migration cooperation.”
 - This reframes what international law treats as **population transfer** into what looks like **normalized migration policy**.
3. **Outsource responsibility.**
- Once Gazans step onto foreign soil, Israel could argue it no longer bears obligations to them, shifting accountability onto the receiving country.
 - But under international law, an occupying power cannot shed responsibility by transferring people out.
4. **Humanitarian narrative.**
- Package the move as a *rescue from famine and conflict*, supported by donor money, with housing and jobs in third countries.
 - That humanitarian gloss undermines the recognition that the famine/blockade itself is Israel’s responsibility.
5. **Judicial insulation at home.**
- Within Israel, legal challenges could be deflected by stressing voluntariness, foreign sovereignty (agreements with other states), and national security discretion. Courts, as in past Gaza rulings, might defer.

4. Comparison with U.S./UK Practices

- **Similarities:** Like the U.S. deportations or UK–Rwanda plan, the Israeli idea leverages *third countries* to skirt legal constraints, reframes coercion as “choice,” and uses financial/aid deals as lubricants.
- **Differences:**
 - U.S./UK cases involve people *arriving at the state’s border* — Israel’s case is unique because the people in question are *indigenous to the territory* under its effective control.
 - That transforms it from an asylum/migration policy into a direct violation of the law of occupation. In international law terms, it crosses from “controversial externalisation” into **potential ethnic cleansing**.

5. Bottom Line

- **Under international law:** Any enacted Israeli proposal to permanently move Palestinians from Gaza to South Sudan (or elsewhere) would amount to an **unlawful forcible transfer**, regardless of how “voluntary” it is branded.
- **Under Israeli law:** It could be *framed* as voluntary migration, and courts might not intervene decisively — giving the government domestic cover.
- **Gaming the law:** The maneuver would lie in dressing up coerced removal as “choice” and outsourcing it through bilateral deals, while denying the coercive context that strips that choice of meaning.

☞ In short: the Israeli proposal would be another — and more extreme — case of what you described with U.S. deportations: **manoeuvring the law against its spirit**. But here, the legal stakes are graver: not just due process violations, but potential crimes under international law.

Would you like me to sketch how international actors (UN, AU, ICC, EU, etc.) might **react differently** to such a move compared to how they've responded to U.S./UK deportation schemes? That would show whether "gaming the law" really protects states in practice.

PROMPTER

So, to underline that point: the UK/USA case is of getting rid of unwanted immigrants to the territory under their political and military control but the Israeli case is of getting rid of an indigenous population from a territory under their political and military control?

CHATGPT

Exactly — you've put your finger on the **crucial legal and moral distinction**.

1. UK / USA Deportation Schemes

- **Nature of control:** Both the UK and USA are acting within their own sovereign territories, dealing with *foreign nationals* who entered or were apprehended on their soil.
- **Objective:** Remove *unwanted migrants* (asylum seekers, irregular entrants, or criminal detainees) from their jurisdiction.
- **Mechanism:** Outsource detention and/or asylum processing to third countries (Rwanda, South Sudan, Albania, etc.).
- **Legal frame:** Controversial in terms of **human rights and refugee law**, but not a violation of the core prohibition on *forcible population transfer*.
- **Principle breached:** Right to due process, non-refoulement, humane treatment of migrants.

2. Israeli Proposal vis-à-vis Gaza

- **Nature of control:** Israel exerts decisive control over Gaza's borders, airspace, sea access, and basic survival conditions — in effect, Gaza is territory under its **belligerent occupation** (even if Israel disputes the terminology).
- **Population involved:** Palestinians who are *indigenous to that land* — not immigrants, not new arrivals, but a population with ancestral and legal claims to remain.
- **Objective:** Remove or incentivize removal of that population to a third country.
- **Legal frame:** This crosses into **forcible transfer of protected persons** under the Fourth Geneva Convention. Unlike deporting foreign nationals, this touches the red line of *ethnic cleansing*.
- **Principle breached:** The right of an occupied people to remain in their homeland — a cornerstone of international humanitarian law.

3. The Core Difference

- **UK / USA:** *Exporting outsiders*. These people do not belong to the national body politic and are being expelled as unwanted. Still rights-violating, but within the paradigm of *migration control*.
- **Israel / Gaza:** *Exporting insiders*. The population is indigenous, rooted, and under the legal protection of international humanitarian law as an occupied

people. Removing them isn't just migration policy — it strikes at the integrity of a people's right to exist in their territory.

4. Why This Matters

That's why the Israeli case isn't just "another Rwanda deal." It lives in a **different legal category**:

- For the U.S. or UK, critics argue hypocrisy, cruelty, and evasion of refugee law.
- For Israel, critics argue **grave breach of the Geneva Conventions** — potentially a **crime against humanity** (forcible transfer, persecution, apartheid) if enacted at scale.

☑ So yes: to underline it exactly as you phrased — the **UK/USA cases concern getting rid of unwanted immigrants**, while the **Israeli case concerns getting rid of an indigenous population from occupied land**. The first is bad law and policy; the second risks sliding into outright *international criminality*.

Would it be useful if I mapped this onto the "**hierarchy of violations**" — showing how each fits into international legal categories (migration law breach, human rights violation, war crime, crime against humanity)? That might sharpen just how different the levels are.

PROMPTER

There is another dimension there: the Israeli proposal is being pushed on the back of actively killing or making life unsustainable for the Palestinian population in Gaza (a genocide). As the Israeli official in the story tries to appeal to Peter Biar, 'people are starving' -- as if, not agreeing to this proposal makes death by bombing or starvation fait accompli for the people of Gaza. Is this a reasonable reading of the story and the prevailing situation?

CHATGPT

Yes — that's a very reasonable and, I would argue, necessary reading of both the **story's dynamics** and the **real-world situation**. Let me unpack why:

1. Context of Starvation and Violence

- Since late 2023, multiple UN agencies (WFP, WHO, UNICEF) and independent bodies (including the ICJ's provisional measures ruling in January 2024) have affirmed that Gaza faces **famine-level hunger** and a **man-made humanitarian catastrophe**.
- This isn't incidental: starvation, denial of aid, bombardment of civilian infrastructure, and blockade are all **acts attributable to Israel's military and political control**.
- In international law terms, the deliberate creation of conditions of life that are *unsustainable for a group* is a defining element of **genocide** (per Article II(c) of the Genocide Convention).

2. How This Intersects With the "Proposal"

- The story's Israeli official essentially argues: "*They will die here if they don't go there.*"
- This frames the transfer as a **humanitarian lifeline** — but only because the same actor is actively creating the lethal conditions.
- Legally, that becomes a textbook case of *coercive displacement under genocidal conditions*: the "choice" to leave is manufactured by making staying impossible.

3. Instrumentalising Starvation

- The appeal to Peter Biar — "people are starving" — is not untrue, but it is **weaponised truth**: a starvation crisis first inflicted, then offered as leverage for relocation.
- In genocide scholarship, this is recognised as a form of *destructive choice*: the victim group faces death **or** displacement, both of which achieve the perpetrator's eliminationist goal.
- That logic is fundamentally different from U.S. or UK deportations. Those are cruel, but not predicated on the *deliberate mass killing* of the population in question.

4. Reasonableness of Your Reading

- **Narrative-wise**: The story captures a real discursive trick: presenting population transfer as a *compassionate alternative*, while obscuring the fact that the coercion originates with the same actor.
- **Politically**: It mirrors Israel's actual diplomacy. Reports since late 2023 mention Israeli officials floating the idea of "voluntary emigration" to third states precisely alongside a military campaign that devastated Gaza.
- **Legally**: That duality (starve + transfer) fits the pattern of genocidal displacement, where one genocidal method (*conditions of life calculated to destroy*) underpins another (*forcible transfer*).

5. The *Fait Accompli* Logic

- The rhetorical move is: "*If you don't cooperate, they will die — and you will share responsibility.*"
- This shifts blame from the perpetrator (who created the famine) to third parties (who refuse to host the displaced).
- It's a classic form of coercive diplomacy — making outsiders complicit unless they enable the solution the perpetrator prefers.

☒ So yes: your reading is absolutely reasonable. In fact, it highlights the **darkest dimension**: the proposal is not just about moving people; it's about laundering a genocidal strategy into a *seemingly humanitarian offer*.

Would you like me to show how this "**choice under genocidal duress**" has parallels in history (e.g., the Armenian genocide, Bosnian war, Darfur) — where starvation or violence was used to make forced displacement appear "voluntary"? That might strengthen how the story resonates with real-world precedents.

PROMPTER

At a cursory glance, it might appear that despite the clear legal and moral differences, such 'third country' deals/proposals by USA/UK and Israel regard South Sudan and African countries like a 'dumping ground' for unwanted or disposable people, not unlike the colonial policy of sending criminals to remote corners of the empire. Is such a perception unreasonable, and what could be the arguments against it?

CHATGPT

No, that perception is **not unreasonable** — there is a strong historical and perceptual logic to it. But it is also **simplified**, and there are counter-arguments that complicate the picture. Let's unpack both sides carefully.

1. Why the “dumping ground” perception arises

1. Historical resonance

- Colonial powers often sent convicts, political prisoners, or otherwise “undesirable” populations to far-flung territories (Australia, Africa, Caribbean). The structural resemblance is hard to ignore: populations deemed undesirable by a powerful state are sent to a distant, weaker state with limited ability to resist.

2. Patterns in recent deals

- U.S. deportations to South Sudan and other African states, the UK–Rwanda scheme, and the Israeli proposal all **target African countries** for relocation of populations unwanted in the sending state.
- Incentives (aid, job programs, infrastructure funding) reinforce the idea that these states are being asked to “absorb” problems rather than participate as equal partners in a cooperative international system.

3. Power asymmetry

- African states are often **structurally weaker**, with limited leverage in negotiations. The sending state can offer financial or political carrots while the African country assumes the risks, echoing coercive colonial logics.

4. Public perception

- Media coverage and official statements often frame African governments as recipients of foreign populations rather than as sovereign actors with their own agency, feeding the “dumping ground” narrative.

2. Arguments against the perception

1. Agency of African governments

- African countries are not passive. South Sudan, Sudan, Somalia, and Rwanda have **actively refused** or conditioned participation. Their ministries issue denials and evaluate deals carefully, reflecting sovereignty and domestic political calculations.
- This shows that the perception of a “dumping ground” ignores **negotiation, selection, and strategic reasoning** by these states.

2. Financial and developmental incentives

- Deals often come with aid packages, capacity-building, or infrastructure support. African governments may accept certain arrangements **strategically**, using the resources to advance national priorities.

- Unlike colonial convicts, these populations are not sent unilaterally; there is at least some negotiation (even if constrained by power asymmetries).
- 3. **Contextual differences in population type**
 - U.S./UK deportees are largely foreign nationals. African countries may accept them as part of an immigration/migration framework.
 - The Israeli proposal differs — it targets an indigenous population under occupation — but not all third-country arrangements are morally equivalent. Lumping all deals together oversimplifies the situation.
- 4. **International legal framework**
 - Some of these arrangements rely on treaties, MOUs, or international migration frameworks. While controversial, this is **different from outright coercive colonial deportation**, which was entirely extralegal and punitive.

3. Synthesis

- **Reasonableness of the perception:**
 - It is reasonable as a **first-glance, historical analogy**. Power asymmetry, targeting of African states, and the notion of “offloading unwanted people” all resonate with colonial patterns.
- **Limits of the perception:**
 - African states exercise agency, negotiate conditions, and may benefit strategically.
 - Modern international law, financial aid structures, and multilateral agreements differentiate these practices from classic colonial “dumping.”
 - Not all populations are equivalent: foreign migrants vs. indigenous peoples under occupation carry very different moral and legal stakes.

☒ Conclusion

- The “dumping ground” analogy captures **structural power dynamics and historical resonance**, making it a **plausible and useful critique** of how these deals are perceived.
- But it **overstates the passivity** of African governments and ignores legal, political, and strategic nuances, so it cannot be taken as a fully accurate characterization.

If you like, I can draft a **table contrasting colonial deportations, USA/UK deals, and the Israeli Gaza proposal**, highlighting where the “dumping ground” analogy holds and where it breaks down. That would make this analysis very concrete.

PROMPTER

Could it be argued that, irrespective of how the targeted African governments try to negotiate their best interests, they are ultimately subject to economic and military disadvantage which curtails their negotiating position - that is precisely why they are targeted? At the same time, the implications are also that since all unwanted people can be, at least in principle, sent to Africa, that suggests that Africa is itself populated by unwanted people from the UK/EU/USA/Israel perspective -- would that be unreasonable?

CHATGPT

Yes — that argument is both **reasonable and grounded in structural realities**, though it's nuanced. Let's break it down carefully.

1. Economic and Military Leverage as a Constraint

1. Structural asymmetry

- African countries, including South Sudan, often operate under **severe economic limitations**, reliance on foreign aid, and **limited military power** compared to Western or regional powers.
- Even if they negotiate for the “best terms” (aid, infrastructure support, conditionality, or safeguards for their own populations), their leverage is fundamentally constrained by **dependency** and **vulnerability**.

2. Targeting rationale

- From the perspective of powerful states, the **combination of weak negotiating power + need for resources** makes African states attractive as “third-country” recipients.
- This aligns with why the U.S. and UK pursued Rwanda, South Sudan, and Eswatini, and why Israel might imagine outreach to these states — they are more likely to **accept or be pressured to accept transfers** that stronger states could not push on richer or militarily stronger countries.

3. Implication for negotiation

- Even if African governments exercise skillful diplomacy, the ultimate **range of choices is limited**: refusal risks loss of aid or cooperation; acceptance risks domestic political backlash or overstretching capacity.
- This structural asymmetry underlines the “dumping ground” perception at a systemic level, not just a narrative one.

2. The “Unwanted People” Implication

1. Conceptual logic

- If states like the U.S., UK, or Israel consider **all populations they wish to remove as eligible for relocation to Africa**, the implicit idea is that Africa is the default receptacle for “undesirable” people.
- Historically, this echoes colonial logics, but in the modern era, it's more a **function of economic and geopolitical hierarchies** than formal empire.

2. Unreasonableness?

- It is **not unreasonable as a critique**. The structural targeting and repeated use of African states in migration or deportation schemes reinforce this perception.
- Ethically and politically, the idea that Africa becomes the “catch-all” for unwanted populations exposes **a global inequality in how human mobility is managed**.

3. Limitations of the argument

- African governments are **not passive receptacles**; they actively weigh deals, refuse proposals, and negotiate conditions.
- Not all relocation programs are equivalent: foreign migrants vs. indigenous populations under occupation (e.g., Gaza) involve **different legal and moral stakes**.

- So while Africa may be **disproportionately targeted**, the “unwanted people” framing is an analytical lens rather than a literal truth about Africa’s population.

3. Synthesis

- **Economic and military disadvantage** → African states are **more vulnerable to being targeted** as relocation partners.
- **Structural targeting** → This creates a system in which Africa is repeatedly positioned as a “default” site for populations unwanted elsewhere.
- **Perceptual implication** → To the extent Western/Israeli policymakers treat Africa as a receptacle for displaced populations, it *implicitly* frames the continent as a place where “unwanted people” belong.
- **Counterpoint** → African states retain agency, can refuse, negotiate, and leverage incentives; and the populations themselves are diverse, with differing legal and ethical contexts.

☒ Conclusion

The argument is **reasonable as a structural and critical perspective**. It highlights systemic inequalities in global migration management and echoes historical patterns of exploitation, even if it overstates passivity or universality. The “unwanted people” framing works as a critique of global power dynamics, but not as an absolute statement about African populations themselves.

If you like, I can **illustrate this as a structural diagram** showing:

1. Sending states (U.S./UK/Israel)
2. Targeted African states
3. Populations to be relocated
4. Power asymmetries and incentives

This would make the “dumping ground / unwanted people” logic visually explicit. Do you want me to do that next?

PROMPTER

Let's pause on the logic of 'aid' in Israel's reported proposal to remove Gazans to South Sudan. Are there confirmed reports of Israel having given or offered aid to South Sudan before or since these reports?

CHATGPT

Yes, Israel has recently provided humanitarian aid to South Sudan, including food assistance. In August 2025, Israel's Foreign Minister Gideon Sa'ar announced that Israel would deliver urgent humanitarian aid to South Sudan in response to a severe cholera outbreak. The aid package, coordinated by MASHAV (Israel’s Agency for International Development Cooperation), included essential medical supplies, water purification equipment, hygiene kits, and food packages. [Anadolu Ajansı+3Ministry of Foreign Affairs+3Arab News+3](#)

This move aligns with Israel's broader foreign aid strategy, which includes providing development assistance and humanitarian aid to various countries, particularly in

Africa. The aid to South Sudan also follows a history of cooperation between the two nations since the establishment of diplomatic relations in 2011 [.Wikipedia](#)

It's important to note that while Israel has offered aid to South Sudan, the South Sudanese government has publicly rejected any proposals to relocate Gazans to their territory. This rejection underscores the complexity of international relations and the agency of African nations in determining their foreign policy and humanitarian priorities.

PROMPTER

As Israel was giving this aid to South Sudan, it was also withholding or obstructing international aid in Gaza and engineering forced starvation - now dubbed 'man-made famine' - there. How might these circumstances play on the strategic interests in South Sudan?

CHATGPT

Exactly — the juxtaposition of **giving aid to South Sudan** while **withholding it from Gaza** creates a highly charged strategic and ethical dynamic, and it would certainly shape how South Sudanese policymakers perceive any proposal to accept Gazans. Let's unpack this:

1. Perception of Leverage

- **Israel's aid as carrot:** Humanitarian assistance to South Sudan (cholera relief, food, medical supplies) signals that Israel can deliver tangible benefits.
- **Withholding aid elsewhere as stick:** The concurrent “man-made famine” in Gaza shows that Israel can also **withhold or restrict life-saving resources**, creating humanitarian crises to achieve political ends.
- **Implication for South Sudan:** Officials may recognize that agreeing to host Gazans could be interpreted as **compliance in exchange for continued or expanded aid**, effectively putting them in a position where humanitarian cooperation is politically instrumentalized.

2. Risk Calculus for South Sudan

1. Reputational risk

- Accepting Gazans might expose South Sudan to international criticism if the transfer is seen as **coerced displacement of a population under duress**, potentially implicating South Sudan in human rights violations.

2. Resource and capacity risk

- Even with Israeli aid, hosting a large displaced population strains infrastructure, health systems, and local markets.
- If Israel's aid is conditional or limited, South Sudan may bear **long-term costs without commensurate benefits**.

3. Strategic bargaining power

- The fact that Israel can alternate between **generosity and obstruction** gives South Sudan reason to be skeptical. Aid could be a lever, but **the asymmetry is stark**: Israel has the resources, South Sudan has the need.

3. Moral and Political Signaling

- **Aid to South Sudan** signals goodwill and partnership, but in the broader context, it **frames South Sudan as a cooperative instrument** in a geopolitical game.
- Simultaneously, **starvation in Gaza communicates coercion**: “If you don’t agree, populations can be left to die.”
- South Sudanese officials might see this as a **strategic test**: compliance could unlock aid and investment, but refusal risks tension with a militarily and economically stronger partner.

4. International Context and Precedent

- Similar dynamics appear in **U.S. and UK third-country deals**: African states are offered aid or development packages to absorb deportees, creating an incentive structure that **capitalizes on economic asymmetry**.
- The difference with Israel’s Gaza context is **the added element of a humanitarian crisis actively engineered by the sending state**, which magnifies moral and legal risk for the receiving country.

5. Likely South Sudanese Strategic Response

- **Caution / public refusal**: As seen in August 2025 statements, South Sudan rejected reports of agreements with Israel, signaling **assertion of agency despite power asymmetries**.
- **Demand for clear terms**: If negotiations were attempted, South Sudan would likely insist on **non-coercive, well-resourced, and legally safe arrangements**, possibly with multilateral oversight.
- **Diplomatic hedging**: South Sudan may accept **aid in humanitarian contexts** (cholera, famine, health) while refusing politically sensitive population transfers, preserving sovereignty and international credibility.

☒ Summary

The dual reality of **Israeli aid to South Sudan** versus **starvation in Gaza** creates both **incentives and ethical dilemmas**:

1. **Incentive**: Israel demonstrates that it can deliver life-saving resources.
2. **Coercion signal**: Gaza’s man-made famine signals that Israel can withhold aid to achieve objectives.
3. **South Sudan’s calculation**: Risk of reputational harm, resource strain, and moral complicity vs. potential benefits from aid.
4. **Strategic outcome**: Likely cautious refusal or conditional engagement — South Sudan asserts agency while navigating asymmetric power.

If you want, I can **map this dynamic visually** as a “carrot-and-stick” model showing how aid to South Sudan and starvation in Gaza function together in Israel’s strategic calculus. This would make the logic crystal clear.

PROMPTER

South Sudan had a protracted civil war after independence in 2011, and recently there have been reports of more civil conflict. How might those circumstances bear upon the Israeli proposal and its reception?

CHATGPT

Absolutely — South Sudan's recent history of protracted conflict and instability is highly relevant to how any Israeli proposal would be perceived and handled. Here's a detailed analysis:

1. Fragile State Context

- **Civil war legacy (2013–2018)**
 - South Sudan's independence was followed by a devastating civil war that killed hundreds of thousands and displaced millions.
 - State institutions remain weak, with limited capacity for governance, security, or social services.
- **Ongoing localized conflict (2023–2025)**
 - Reports indicate renewed inter-communal violence, political factionalism, and clashes among militias.
 - Humanitarian infrastructure is fragile: healthcare, sanitation, food distribution, and refugee hosting capacity are all highly constrained.

2. Implications for the Israeli Proposal

1. Capacity concerns

- Hosting a significant number of Gazans would strain an already fragile state. Even with promised aid, South Sudan would struggle to provide security, housing, health services, and livelihoods.
- This makes any deal **operationally risky** and politically sensitive domestically.

2. Security risks

- Large-scale population transfers can exacerbate local tensions.
- Existing militias or communities may resist the influx of foreigners, risking outbreaks of violence or attacks on the new population.
- The government would need to commit scarce security resources, potentially undermining its authority elsewhere.

3. International scrutiny

- Sending displaced Palestinians to a country in ongoing internal conflict could **draw condemnation** from the UN, AU, and human rights organizations.
- South Sudanese officials would be aware that agreeing to such a proposal could **invite reputational and legal risks**, potentially being accused of complicity in coerced displacement.

4. Domestic political calculus

- Leaders must weigh whether accepting Gazans would be **politically sustainable**.
- Citizens, internally displaced persons, and local elites may see the newcomers as competitors for aid, land, or employment, increasing political instability.

3. Strategic Implications

- **Increased bargaining power for South Sudan**

- Fragility gives South Sudan an incentive to reject proposals that could destabilize the country; it can argue “we lack capacity” and therefore **avoid moral or operational complicity**.
- **Vulnerability to coercion**
 - Conversely, Israel might see fragility as an opportunity: offering aid or incentives to a government desperate for resources could create pressure to comply.
- **Risk of failure or blowback**
 - Even if South Sudan agreed, implementation could fail due to security breakdowns, local resistance, or humanitarian collapse, reflecting poorly on both Israel and the South Sudanese government.

4. Overall Assessment

- The combination of **historical conflict, ongoing violence, and weak institutions** makes South Sudan a **very risky proposition** for any large-scale population transfer.
- From the perspective of South Sudanese policymakers:
 1. **High operational cost** (security, logistics, resources)
 2. **High political cost** (domestic backlash, destabilization)
 3. **High reputational/legal cost** (complicity in coerced displacement under international law)
- These factors likely **strengthen South Sudan’s official rejection** of the Israeli proposal.

☒ **Conclusion:**

South Sudan’s history of civil war and ongoing instability makes it **structurally and politically inhospitable** to the proposed relocation of Gazans. Even if Israel offered aid, the country’s fragility amplifies the risks — operational, political, and legal — and explains why South Sudan has publicly refused such proposals.

If you want, I can also analyze **how similar fragility has influenced African states’ responses** to U.S./UK deportation schemes, highlighting patterns of risk assessment and selective acceptance. This could provide a comparative perspective.

PROMPTER

Is there any report or commentary you can access which gives a sense of how civil society within South Sudan has responded to the reported proposal? In the story you mention Peter following these reports carefully, what is the recorded South Sudanese civil society perspective?

CHATGPT

Yes, South Sudanese civil society has expressed significant concern over the reported Israeli proposal to relocate Palestinians from Gaza to South Sudan. Civil society leaders have publicly rejected the idea, emphasizing the risks it poses to both Palestinians and South Sudanese citizens.[Devdiscourse+3The Grio+3AP News+3](#)

Civil Society's Response

A leader from a South Sudanese civil society group highlighted the potential dangers of resettling Palestinians in South Sudan, citing historical tensions with Muslims and Arabs in the region. The leader warned that such a move could lead to renewed hostilities and emphasized that South Sudan should not become a "dumping ground" for displaced populations. [Responsible Statecraft+1](#)

Government's Position

The South Sudanese government has officially denied reports of holding talks with Israel about resettling Palestinians from Gaza. The Ministry of Foreign Affairs issued a statement refuting the claims, stating that the reports were "unfounded" and "not reflective of our position or policy." [vinnews.com+4JNS.org+4almanassa.com+4Yeshiva World News](#)

International and Humanitarian Perspectives

International organizations and human rights groups have also criticized the proposal, arguing that relocating Palestinians to South Sudan could amount to forced displacement and violate international law. Critics warn that such a move would not only endanger the displaced individuals but could also destabilize an already fragile South Sudan. [AP News](#)

In summary, both South Sudanese civil society and the government have expressed strong opposition to the reported Israeli proposal, citing humanitarian, security, and legal concerns.

Prompter's note:

One of the prompts quotes from a US Homeland Security announcement of 5 July 2025, entitled: "8 Barbaric Criminal Illegal Aliens Finally Deported to South Sudan After Weeks of Delays by Activist Judges". This is found at: <https://www.dhs.gov/news/2025/07/05/8-barbaric-criminal-illegal-aliens-finally-deported-south-sudan-after-weeks-delays>

One of the prompts suggests some scepticism about the phrase 'man-made famine'. This is because it obscures genocidal intent to some degree, since the phrase has conventionally had two senses, of which one is dominant. The two senses are succinctly explained in the following quotation – the first has tended to be dominant:

While there exists a vast literature on natural events that affect food supplies, there is a much more limited literature on such man-made famines. There are two kinds: the first kind of man-made famine occurs as the result of the unintended consequences of economic, political, and social processes that aggravate rather than ameliorate an existing shortage of food caused by natural events [...]. The second kind of man-made famine is the result of the age-old and intentional use of hunger as a weapon in conflict and warfare [...]. (Kurt Jonassohn with Karin Solveig Björnson, *Genocide and Gross Human Rights Violations*, New Brunswick: Transaction, 1999, p.26)

The intent in relation to Gaza is perhaps more clearly expressed with a phrase like 'forced starvation', or more precisely albeit clumsily, 'forced fatal mass starvation'.